

## MUMBAI | Tired in Retirement

A month after Uddhav Thackeray made his first speech at the Shiv Sena's annual Dussehra rally, party supremo Bal Thackeray signalled his retirement from active politics. The senior Thackeray urged party workers to avoid calling on him after discussing issues with Uddhav, saying that such meetings tire him in his old age. "When I have handed over the reigns of the party to Uddhav, what is the need to come and meet me?" he wrote in *Saamna*, the Sena's mouthpiece. This hasn't gone down too well with Sainiks who will now not get an opportunity to meet their party chief.

However, while the senior Thackeray may be exhausted, his estranged nephew Raj Thackeray is hogging the lime-light. The Maharashtra Navnirman Sena (MNS) chief is coming to grips with a bounty on his head. Kishor Samrite, a Samajwadi



BAL THACKERAY WITH UDDHAV

Party MLA from Madhya Pradesh, has announced a reward of Rs 1 crore to anyone who will kill Raj. The declaration, made during an interview to a news channel, has the MNS up in arms. **by Aditi Pai**

## Left Right

**With the comrades pulling out of the government and the global financial system in turmoil, marketeer Manmohan Singh is suddenly turning Marxist. At the forthcoming Washington summit, his presentation includes the success story of India's bank nationalisation.**

## PATNA | The Raj Harvest

Bihar politicians were quick to encash Raj Thackeray's ire on north Indians. First, JD(U) chief Sharad Yadav declared that his party's MPs would quit if the Centre didn't act against the MNS chief. Then, RJD chief Lalu Prasad Yadav offered to quit along with all his MPs and MLAs. But Chief Minister Nitish Kumar says that the resignations "will put Bihar under President's rule, which Lalu wants for Maharashtra". **by Amitabh Srivastava**



## golden pumpkin

COULD THEY actually be just misunderstood? If you believe captain Ricky Ponting, all that Australia's hard-bitten cricket team does on the field is have friendly chats. The verbal stoushes in the current series actually "looked worse from the sidelines than they tend to be on the field." Well, that's only if it's one of Ponting's lot mouthing off, of course, like Mitchell Johnson did at VVS Laxman. Ponting was quick to deny that that had anything to do with his team dismissing the Indians only once in six innings during the series. No offence Punter, but that's just lame.



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